

PA.5 Forms & Documents Index

Every document this build will generate: what it is, which office it comes from, and when it is due.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Pennsylvania is not a no-code state and it is not a no-inspection state: the Uniform Construction Code applies to every house in the Commonwealth, and five inspections are required on every one of them. What changes from one municipality to the next is *who performs them* — a municipal code official, an agency the municipality retained, or, where the municipality elected not to administer the code at all, an agency **you** hire yourself. Fees, review queues and the local permits stacked on top of the building permit vary too. Confirm every item with the office that will actually handle your parcel before you rely on it.

There is no Commonwealth building permit application form. The form belongs to your municipality or to the third-party agency you engage, and it will not look like anyone else's. What *is* consistent is the set of documents a Pennsylvania house generates, so that is what this index covers. Work down it and mark what your project actually triggers.

BEFORE THE BUILDING PERMIT

Approvals that come before, or with, the permit

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Municipal UCC election lookup	Not a form — a lookup. L&I publishes a table of every municipality with its opt-in or opt-out decision and the building code official's name. Settles who you are dealing with. See PA.4.	PA L&I	First
Zoning permit or zoning approval	Confirms the use, the setbacks and the height are allowed. Entirely separate from the UCC and unaffected by an opt-out election — the municipality issues this either way.	Municipality	Before permit
Sewage permit (on-lot systems)	Issued by the municipality through its sewage enforcement officer under the Sewage Facilities Act. Preceded by soil testing and a percolation test. Not a UCC document — 34 Pa. Code § 403.21(e) puts on-lot sewage outside the code entirely.	Municipal SEO	Before permit

Approvals that come before, or with, the permit

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Sewage planning module	The Act 537 planning step for a new lot, where an exemption does not apply. Runs through the municipality to DEP and is the slowest item on many rural projects.	Municipality and DEP	Before sewage permit
Highway occupancy permit	Required for a driveway meeting a state highway. The building permit must carry notice that an HOP is required. PennDOT has 60 days to act or the permit is deemed issued.	PennDOT	Before permit
Erosion and sediment control plan	Earth disturbance triggers an E&S plan, and larger disturbance triggers an NPDES construction stormwater permit through the county conservation district. Confirm your threshold with the district — see PA.4.	County conservation district	Before ground is broken
Construction documents	Plans and specifications. No architect or engineer seal is required for a house — but a licensed design professional's <i>certification</i> that the plans meet the UCC cuts the review clock from 15 business days to 5.	You or your designer	With application
Site plan	Required by regulation, not courtesy: size and location of new and existing structures and their distance from lot lines (34 Pa. Code § 403.62a(e)).	You	With application
Flood hazard data	Only if the lot is in a mapped flood hazard area: boundaries, zones, design flood elevation and proposed lowest floor elevation (§ 403.62a(d)).	You / surveyor	With application
The municipality's list of other required permits	You are entitled to it by statute — and the same sentence says the municipality is not liable for its completeness. Ask in writing, then verify each item yourself.	Municipality	At application

DURING THE JOB

Documents the build itself generates

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Building permit	Municipal or agency form. Keep a copy on the work site until construction is complete (§ 403.63(h)). Invalid if work does not begin within 180 days; valid no more than 5 years.	Municipality or agency	Before work
Stamped construction documents	The official stamps or notes each page as reviewed and approved and returns a set with any required changes marked. Keep them on site, open to inspection (§ 403.63(c)).	Reviewer	At issuance
Third-party agency engagement letter	Opt-out municipalities only, and the most important document you will negotiate. Scope, fees, re-inspection charges, response times, and what happens when you disagree — because you have no statutory appeal (PA.3).	You and the agency	Before work
PA One Call ticket	Utility line location before excavation. Confirm whether the homeowner exemption reaches your situation — it does not extend to contractors you hire.	PA One Call	Before digging
Revised construction documents	Any change from the approved documents requires a revised set and an additional plan review (§§ 403.63(j), 7210.502(a)(1)).	You	On any change
Inspection records	The official notifies you whether work complies or fails (§ 403.64(c)). Log every one — see the log in PA.3.	Official or agency	Each inspection
Energy compliance documentation	REScheck output, or the “Pennsylvania Alternative Residential Energy Provisions” package. Plus the blower door test result — 3.0 ACH50 across the whole Commonwealth.	You / rater	Permit and final

CLOSING OUT

Documents that end the job

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Final inspection report	Filed by the official and indicating UCC compliance. A third-party agency must send a copy to the property owner, the builder and a lender designated by the builder.	Official or agency	After final
Certificate of occupancy	You may not occupy without it. Due within 5 business days of a compliant final report — 10 in Philadelphia. Check that it names the construction code edition.	Building code official	Before you move in
Sewage system final approval	The SEO's sign-off on the installed system, on its own track from the UCC final.	Municipal SEO	Before use
Well completion report	Where a well is drilled, the driller files a completion record with the Commonwealth. Ask your driller for a copy for your own file — see PA.4.	Well driller	After drilling

THE DOCUMENTS NOBODY WILL ASK YOU FOR

This is the group that catches owner-builders, and it catches them quietly. On a normal build a general contractor produces these; acting as your own contractor does not remove them from the job, it removes the person who was producing them. None of them is filed with a government office, which is exactly why nobody chases you for one.

Paper that exists only because you are your own contractor

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Written subcontracts	Your new house is outside HICPA, so none of its mandatory terms apply automatically. PA.1 lists the terms the Commonwealth compels on a remodel — a capped deposit, a 10% time-and-materials ceiling, written change orders, stated insurance — to copy into your own agreements.	You	Before each trade starts
Certificates of insurance	From every subcontractor, naming coverage limits and dates. HICPA's remodel benchmark is \$50,000 personal injury and \$50,000 property damage; on a new house you set the number, so set it deliberately.	Each sub	Before each trade starts

Paper that exists only because you are your own contractor

Document	What it is	Comes from	When
Workers' compensation evidence	Ask every sub for proof of coverage for their own people, and keep it. An uninsured worker injured on your lot is a problem that arrives long after the work is done.	Each sub	Before each trade starts
Lien waivers	Exchanged for payment, so that paying your contractor also clears the claims of the people behind them. Confirm the current requirements with a Pennsylvania attorney before you rely on a form from the internet.	You and each payee	At every payment
Photographic record	Photograph every wall cavity, every rough-in and every connection before it is covered. In an opt-out municipality this matters twice over: the inspection file sits with a private company, and you have no statutory appeal if a dispute arises.	You	Ongoing
The kit itself	Keep PA.3's inspection log and PA.4's confirmed-offices page with the permit. Together they are the continuous record of the build that no single office holds.	You	Ongoing

One document you will want in fifteen years

When you sell, Pennsylvania's Real Estate Seller Disclosure Law obliges you to disclose known material defects — and an owner-built house invites questions no other seller gets: was it permitted, was it inspected, where is the certificate of occupancy. A complete permit file answers all three in one envelope. An incomplete one is the reason some owner-built houses sell at a discount, and it is the strongest practical argument for doing the paperwork properly even where nobody is checking.

Sources — every Pennsylvania claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
No statewide permit application; site plan and flood hazard submissions	34 Pa. Code § 403.62a
Design professional certification shortens review to 5 business days	35 P.S. § 7210.502(a)(1)
Municipality must provide the list of other required permits	35 P.S. § 7210.502(a)(1)
On-lot sewage is outside the UCC	34 Pa. Code § 403.21(e)

Sources — every Pennsylvania claim in this document (verified September 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Highway occupancy permit notice; PennDOT's 60-day clock	35 P.S. § 7210.502(b)
Permit kept on site; 180 days; 5 years; revisions need a new review	34 Pa. Code § 403.63(c), (g), (h), (j)
Final report to owner, builder and lender; certificate of occupancy	34 Pa. Code §§ 403.64(g), 403.65
HICPA contract terms used here as a drafting benchmark	73 P.S. §§ 517.7(a), 517.9(10)

Every source cited here is free to read, but Pennsylvania keeps statutes and regulations on **two different websites**. A citation reading **Pa. Code** is a regulation — pacodeandbulletin.gov, by title and chapter. A citation reading **P.S.** is a statute, and it is **not on that site at all**; the Pa. Code home page says so outright. Statutes are at legis.state.pa.us → Unconsolidated Statutes, by year and act number — the Construction Code Act is Act 45 of 1999. **One warning:** every Pa. Code chapter prints the Pennsylvania Bulletin issue it is current through, and an amendment published later is already law. Read that line first. All text here was read at those sources, September 2026.